

Academics Primary School/Program to Which You Are Applying

College of Arts & Sciences

Primary Major of Interest

Undecided-Interdisciplinary

University of Pennsylvania**Writing**

1) Write a short thank-you note to someone you have not yet thanked and would like to acknowledge. (We encourage you to share this note with that person, if possible, and reflect on the experience!) (150-200 words,

Gratitude Question

Dear Mikey, Remember when I let out a blood-curdling scream? A baboon had snatched my bag and rifled through it in search of anything edible. But you stepped up. You showed me how to be fearless even in the bleakest of times; even if it meant making a fool of yourself. I want to sincerely thank you, Mike, for puffing up your chest, making the most outrageous animal noises and clapping like a maniac, all for my benefit. You scared away the baboon, who fled in terror, dropping my bag with my newly purchased avocados. You're truly a lifesaver and considerate to boot for having remembered my wish to have a lifetime supply of avocados! Thank you, Mike, for being a true hero that day and on all of our other hilarious adventures. Your unique and amusing approach to solving problems likely saved me from a difficult situation, and I will always be grateful to you. I have found many reasons to laugh on the most mundane days. Thank you for showing me the value of brightening up the duller moments. You rock! I appreciate you for the amazing cousin you are. With Love. Macharia

2) How will you explore community at Penn? Consider how Penn will help shape your perspective and identity, and how your identity and perspective will help shape Penn. (150-200 words)

Community Question

"Come on Macharia!" Grandmother said. She played 'Gitiro', a popular Kikuyu song, and began to dance. I watched and copied her flawless movements, eventually mastering the shoulder twist move. She explained that the traditional dance allowed young people to freestyle and create a new, unique community dance. At Light's Dance Club, I brought the same sense of creativity and inclusivity. While choreographing the 'Avulekile' dance, I let everyone share their dance moves. We built off each other's ideas until we came up with a unifying melange of cultures. As a result, everyone's personal touch made the dance meaningful and inclusive. . I hope to embrace inclusivity in dance at the Penn Dance Company. I will do it by starting a "Dance Fusion Initiative". It will feature dances - from Arabic to Zulu - representing all cultures on campus. It will encompass students of all skill levels and backgrounds, fully reflecting the diversity of the Penn dance community. Ultimately, it will be unparalleled in its embrace of

people from all walks of life. At Penn, “oil meets water” as my interests, beliefs, and culture differ so much from my peers that when we cross pathways, casual conversations turn into learning.

3) Considering the specific undergraduate school you have selected, describe how you intend to explore your academic and intellectual interests at the University of Pennsylvania. (150-200 words)

School Question

Day #19

6am... My alarm blared, I prepared, & headed over to the DIMACS Center for Discrete Mathematics. Professor Ted Chinburg explained intriguing concepts about cryptography. I learned how combinatorics is used to securely decrypt and encrypt data in financial transactions. Afterward, I headed to Professor Jonathan Block’s lab, where he shared insights on the K-Theory. We planned to research to potentially contribute new knowledge in the field.

11am... Brought another historical image to life as I wrote another essay from a picture in Paul Hendrickson’s Writing from Photographs class. Afterward, I went to the Penn Quant Trading Club, where I got insights into mean reversion in trading.

2pm... Through Lunch & Learn, I discussed the misconceptions of African-American culture with Professor Josephine Park over delicious Philly cheese steaks. We discussed the ‘Mammy’ stereotype in “Gone with the Wind” and how it influences marginalization of certain voices.

4pm... I headed to the Center for Environmental Building & Design for my Environmental Studies class. I presented ways of implementing urban forests in cities to mitigate the heat island effect. I discussed an innovative approach to incorporating rainwater harvesting systems with green roofs to address food security in urban areas.